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FEATURES

this monolithic café in south korea is designed to evoke an ancient fortress

kat barandy | designboom · designboom Architecture

Monologue Café: A colossal sculpture in the landscape

Korean studio SOSOKKI ANAC takes to a forested landscape in Gangwon-do to design this Monologue Café as a series of angular brick volumes. The monolithic structure rises from the ground in sharp, deliberate formations. The building reads as a continuous mass, its surfaces folded and inclined, with each plane catching light differently across the day.

Set along a quiet edge of water and low vegetation, the project avoids a single, fixed viewpoint. As visitors move around it, the café shifts in profile, sometimes appearing compact and vertical, elsewhere stretched and low against the terrain. The reddish brick facade gives the structure a consistent material presence, while the geometry introduces variation through depth, shadow, and projection.

images © Seokgue Hong

SOSOKKI ANAC evokes a fortress

SOSOKKI ANAC, the architects behind the Monologue Café, begin the design with a speculative concept: a monastery imagined from a time before a reset of the world. This narrative is translated into architecture through the use of layered, faceted forms that suggest accumulation rather than composition. Each volume feels placed in relation to another to build a sense of density and continuity across the site.

References to a monumental boundary condition inform the project's massing, with thick walls and abrupt angles reinforcing a sense of separation and threshold. These gestures are expressed through brick planes that sculpturally tilt, fold, and intersect, thus creating moments where the building reads as both solid and cut.

Monologue Café stands in a forested landscape in Korea as a sculptural brick structure

Interior spaces shaped by light and section

Interiors shift to an atmosphere of pale surfaces and filtered light. Sloped walls and narrow sections guide movement through the space, creating a sequence of compressed and expanded areas. Seating is arranged along elongated corridors, where tables align with angled windows that frame views outward to trees and ground cover.

Large triangular openings define key moments within the café. These apertures bring in daylight with precision, casting changing patterns across the interior surfaces. The geometry of the openings echoes the exterior form, establishing continuity between inside and outside while also directing attention toward the surrounding landscape.

the building shifts in form depending on movement around its angular volumes

folded brick planes create depth through shadow and a sense of layered mass

the design draws from the concept of a monastery from a forgotten civilization

thick walls and sharp geometries evoke the feeling of a fortress

interior spaces are defined by sloped walls and elongated corridors

materials remain restrained with pale surfaces contrasting the exterior brick mass

project info:

name: Monologue Café

architect: SOSOKKI ANAC | @soso_ant101

location: Gangwon-do, South Korea

lead architects: Gi-tae Chung

technical team: WA20 Architects

general contractor: Starsis

landscape architecture: Natural space

area: 455 square meters

completion: 2025

photography: © Seokgue Hong

The post this monolithic café in south korea is designed to evoke an ancient fortress appeared first on [designboom | architecture & design magazine](#) .

30 Light and Bright Spring Dinner Recipes

Lindsay · Pinch of Yum

Spring is in the air – I can feel it! My weekly dinner menus are slowly turning over from soups and stews to salads and bowls filled with lots and lots of color.

This is the only list you need as we head into warmer, sunnier weather! * Some of my all-time favorite dinner recipes for spring are here – bright salads, easy sandwiches for a crowd, herby sauces and dressings, and lots of weeknight wonders (because spring is BUSY, too!).

Hoping you find a new dinner favorite!

Roasted Peanut Kale Crunch Salad

OOOH BABY, this salad is so good! Crunchy kale and cabbage, fresh herbs and fresno peppers, chopped peanuts, and a perfect roasted peanut vinaigrette that tucks into all the salad nooks and crannies.

34 reviews / 4.9 average

[make this recipe](#)

Sun-Dried Tomato Focaccia Turkey Sandwich

Pillowy sun-dried tomato focaccia gets piled with pesto mayo, turkey, juicy tomato slices, and greens. This sandwich is a beauty and practically a lifestyle!

46 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Spring Roll Bowls with Sweet Garlic Lime Sauce

Spring Roll Bowls – basil, mint, rice noodles, fish sauce, brown sugar, lime juice, and whatever other protein and veggies you have on hand! Easy to make meatless!

110 reviews / 4.8 average

[make this recipe](#)

Salmon Tacos with Mango Corn Salsa

Super easy salmon tacos loaded with a mango, sweet corn, and cucumber salsa!

30 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Avocado Mojo Bowls with Sweet Potato and Chicken

We are living our best bowl life this week. Seasoned sweet potato wedges and chicken meatballs or rotisserie chicken all piled onto a plate with a little puddle of punchy green avocado mojo sauce. Yes, wow, repeat.

34 reviews / 4.9 average

[make this recipe](#)

Shredded cabbage and kale, shrimp, avocado, cilantro and chili-flavored peanuts, and the perfect sweet miso dressing.

35 reviews / 4.9 average

[make this recipe](#)

Cilantro Orange Chicken with Rice and Beans

This golden Cilantro Orange Chicken is so flavorful, crisped to golden brown perfection, and just very finger-licking good! Served with rice, beans, and a quick homemade pineapple salsa.

45 reviews / 4.6 average

[make this recipe](#)

Golden brown chicken meatballs cozied up next to fixings like cucumbers, shallots, kewpie mayo, mint, a bit of chili crisp, and some fresh cilantro to make the ultimate chicken sando!

45 reviews / 4.8 average

[make this recipe](#)

Liz's Bistro Salad

Crunchy, light, bright, and ultra-fresh. This French-inspired bistro salad is an absolute star as a side for nearly any dinner. Tender greens, fresh herbs, pickled onions, and a delicate vinaigrette on top.

20 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

Chipotle Orange Shrimp with Cilantro Rice

Chipotle Orange Shrimp with Cilantro Rice! Tender shrimp in a sweet-meets-smoky cream sauce piled high on cilantro-speckled rice with a side of tangy cucumbers.

45 reviews / 4.8 average

[make this recipe](#)

Harissa Meatballs with Whipped Feta

These Harissa Meatballs with Whipped Feta are perfect for an easy SOS dinner! Store-bought meatballs, bell peppers, zucchini, harissa, and whipped feta all in one bowl. YUMMY!

39 reviews / 5 average

[make this recipe](#)

how the creative impulse of utopia improves the world – maria arana zubiате

Maria Arana Zubiате · designboom Architecture

Two natures, one ambiguity, and the danger of its absence

Over time, utopias, often disparaged, have shown their capacity to guide and shape the evolution of the world toward more desirable scenarios. The power of utopia is such that many of today's widely accepted urban proposals— such as collective housing, garden cities, or mass public transport — were once dismissed as utopian. Over the past century, utopia became a powerful tool for accelerating change. After the First World War, the historian, philosopher, and urbanist Lewis Mumford, author of the book *The Story of Utopias*, argued that the most important task of the moment was to 'build castles in the air,' advocating for a proactive, creative, and visionary attitude toward a world that could not be accepted as desirable or just.

As Mumford pointed out, the history of utopias is, in fact, the history of the world. They emerge as a rejection of the social and cultural context of their time, not as a naive refuge, but as a critical gaze that reveals the shortcomings of their present. Utopia is, in itself, a way of understanding reality, a way of seeing the world that allows us to imagine other rules, other connections, and other architectures. And it begins with an impulse that precedes any method: a creative reaction that pushes us to imagine the impossible.

not all utopias are the same

Lewis Mumford divided utopias into two main categories: escapist utopias, which flee from reality, and regenerative utopias, which seek to transform it. Furthermore, he warned of the dangerous proximity between dystopia and the realized utopia: when the ideal is realized, it runs the risk of degenerating into its opposite. How can we differentiate these utopias and find the boundary that turns them into dystopia? How can we work with this ambiguity to recover the drive that fosters utopian thinking within a dystopia? Here is a small selection of projects from *Eutopias*, *Ou-topias*, the main exhibition of the Basque International Architecture Biennial, Mugak, which may help explain this complexity.

Utopias of Escape: Imaginaries Between Critique and Desire

Utopias of escape offer an imaginary refuge from the contradictions of the present and function as cultural safety valves that express the desire for a different possible life and constitute forms of critical escape. From nomadism, voluntary confinement, or adaptive architectures, all of them explore escape as voluntary exclusion—geographical and existential—through the creation of new imaginaries.

New Babylon is the name that Dutch artist Constant Nieuwenhuys gave to a large-scale project developed between 1956 and 1974. Conceived as a global city, free of borders, composed of large, elevated, and transformable structures, New Babylon presents itself as a space in con-

stant metamorphosis, designed to welcome a humanity liberated from productive labor and fully dedicated to play, creation, and experimental living. A territory of freedom and exploration in which architecture ceases to be a fixed framework and becomes a malleable instrument of social experimentation.

Today, Constant's proposal remains remarkably relevant. In the face of a globalized urban model marked by the standardization of spaces, the commodification of leisure, and the centrality of productivity, New Babylon challenges the contemporary imagination by positioning play, mobility, and creativity as the axes of spatial organization. The growing dematerialization of work, the nomadic mobility of broad social sectors, and the expansion of global communication networks seem to give substance—albeit in a fragmentary and contradictory manner—to some of Constant's intuitions. At the same time, the climate and migration crisis, inequality, and the transformation of dwelling practices reopen the interest in thinking of the city as a collective project oriented toward emancipation rather than solely toward economic efficiency.

New Babylon is the name that Dutch artist Constant Nieuwenhuys gave to a large-scale project developed between 1956 and 1974.

Maria Arana Zubiате

Regenerative utopias: Experimental cartographies for the future

In an urban world marked by deep inequalities, architectural imagination can be a political and transformative tool. Regenerative utopias seek to reverse the physical and social deterioration of cities, not only by recovering what has been lost, but by proposing new ways of living and coexisting. Here architecture ceases to be mere construction and becomes a medium that creates bonds, projects futures, and draws new maps of possibilities. Two experiences stand out in this context:

The Available City, conceived by architect and urban planner David Brown, is a proposal for urban intervention based on a striking statistic: the city of Chicago has approximately 13,000 vacant lots, an area equivalent to twice the size of its downtown core. David Brown proposes viewing these vacant sites as an interconnected system rather than isolated lots, to create new public spaces and reconfigure the urban fabric starting from the plot, its smallest unit. In 2021, this concept was chosen as the central theme of the 4th Chicago Architecture Biennial, becoming a laboratory for urban experimentation. The results included play spaces, sports facilities, temporary cultural centers, and community gardens, demonstrating the versatility of the model and its capacity to generate networks of collaboration between architects, residents, collectives, and public administration.

The Coolest Spring 2026 Jacket Trends For Transitional-Weather Dressing

Andrea Bossi · Refinery29 Fashion

It's that time of year again when we've kissed an hour of sleep goodbye in exchange for longer moments with the sun. That means it's also time to pack up your puffers and wool coats in preparation for breezy spring weather. While some categories of clothes may be in an anti-trend, classic era, like denim, jackets are doing the complete opposite. They're full of fun, personality, and an air of cool.

The hottest jacket styles this spring do everything from putting twists on a classic piece to reimagining a traditional silhouette. A trench coat? It's no longer the long, khaki staple but chopped to a shorter proportion and made with fresh materials. Funnel neck coats, which swept the scene last fall, continue their reign. Many of these have trickled down from runways, while others are driven by broader cultural moments.

"There's a real focus on versatility. Jackets have become the outfit, not just the finishing layer," Sarah Bonello, founder of The Park, tells Refinery29. "There's a desire to feel put-together but not overworked. That's why you're seeing these more relaxed, layering-friendly silhouettes like trenches and capes. There's also a shift toward more intentional dressing, fewer pieces, but styled in a way that feels thoughtful."

Read on to discover the coolest spring jacket trends to shop as you start refreshing and revamping your closet, with some tidbits from our favorite fashion people. Plus, peruse our top shopping picks, from more affordable to designer options.

DashDividers_1_500x100

Capes and Capelets

In the midst of fashion's romance revival, it makes sense that capes would come back into the limelight. "They bring this sense of movement and quiet drama that feels fresh," Bonello says.

The style feels inextricably linked to fantasy and costume, whether that's Cate Blanchett playing a seraphic elf in *Lord of the Rings* or Marilyn Monroe's cheeky cheetah cape in *Gentlemen Prefer Blondes*. It's no surprise that famously whimsical and romantic designers like Alessandro Michele featured capes on his Spring/Summer 2026 Valentino runway; Jonathan Anderson also showed them in his debut show.

These regal-feeling jackets can pair well with just about anything, whether we're talking a khaki cropped cape with jeans or a sweeping cape worn over a matching set. Their more subdued interpretation, capelets, are also trending.

DashDividers_1_500x100

Trench Coats With a Twist

As fashion photographer Sophie Elgort tells Refinery29, "The trench is a forever piece. It evolves each season but never disappears." And this spring, trench coats typically go one of two routes: they're cropped (very petite-friendly) or have a freaky detail.

One of the easiest ways to achieve the spring 2026 trend is by simply cropping the traditional trench coat into something that hits at the hips or slightly above. "The proportions are magic and do all the work. Defined waist and legs for days," designer and creator Carla Rockmore tells Refinery29 on the cropped trench look. "Then, you have all those delicious details: buttons, cuffs, a self-belt, which makes it feel intentional without trying too hard."

This spring is also all about trench coats with tweaks to their lapels, like swapping in a shiny leather or checkered fabric for the classic gabardine. These little changes add an edgy and playful touch to something timeless.

DashDividers_1_500x100

We may have colloquially kissed "girlboss" goodbye, but we certainly haven't stopped power dressing. This spring's boxy blazers are distinct from well-tailored jackets that hug the body and highlight the waist. Instead, these spacious and oversized versions don't constrain movement, but let the body move more freely. This means comfort is built into this style, which projects authority and confidence. We witnessed these rise from runways like Victoria Beckham and Acne Studios to our favorite street style moments.

"I've been really inspired by how tailoring is becoming softer and more fluid."

Andrea Bossi

"I've been really inspired by how tailoring is becoming softer and more fluid. Blazers are effortless," Bonello says. "I'll throw one on with our Joy leggings or even just a simple Park bodysuit, and it instantly makes the look feel more considered without trying too hard. It's one of those pieces that does the work for you."

DashDividers_1_500x100

Bomber jackets never lost their appeal, but they seem to be caught up in the wave of those 2016 nostalgic-driven trends coming back ten years later. But today, it's not just about the classic, cool-girl leather bomber. There are also some other fabrications in the mix, like bubble hem cottons and slinky nylons.

When Chloé Creative Director Chemena Kamali revealed her own flouncy bombers in her Spring/Summer 2026 collection, she framed her design process as one takes out all the stiffness. "No wonder the trendiest bombers this season balance the classic leather look with something more contemporary and feminine."

Baker Bleu: Where Breaking Bread is a Space-Making Ritual

Joseph Sgambati III · Design Milk Architecture

Bread crackling, trays clanking, and cutlery clinking as pieces of stainless steel silverware meet their ceramic counterparts. These are some of the sounds emanating from Baker Bleu, Cremorne. Designed by IF Architecture for Melbourne's cult-favorite bakery, the flagship café transforms the daily ritual of buying a loaf into a spatial narrative about craft, process, and continual refinement. Here, dark-crusted sourdough and still-warm bagels are displayed like sculptural objects, set against an interior that is at once industrial and intimate—precise in its execution, deeply human in sensory experience.

The project marks an evolution for the Baker Bleu brand, shaped through an ongoing collaboration between architect and baker. That dialogue most directly influenced the spatial choreography. Bread moves from oven to trolley to customer with minimal interruption. If you arrive at the right moment, your loaf is handed over warm. Immediacy is preserved not just as a culinary value, it is also baked into the design as an architectural principle. The proximity between back-of-house production and front-of-house display was carefully compressed, ensuring that operational efficiency and experiential authenticity work in tandem.

From the outset, the bakery was conceived as a stage for bread-making. The contrast is deliberate: raw, gnarly loaves set against a monolithic, reductionist backdrop. A textured aluminium point-of-sale rises to meet a polished stainless-steel counter, punctuated by baked goods meticulously arranged. Even angled shelving and peg displays reinforce the ritual of handling—each loaf lifted, turned, and passed across the counter with care.

At the heart of the material narrative is recycled aluminium panelling, its surface subtly referencing the alveoli, which are the airy cavities formed during sourdough's three-day fermentation process. The metaphor is both poetic and pragmatic. Composed of recycled content, the panelling reinforces Baker Bleu's broader commitment to sustainability while embedding meaning directly into the walls and ceiling. The material wraps upward, lining the ceiling plane and softening acoustics, while exposed services retain an industrial frankness. In this way, the architecture quietly tells the story of how bread is made through texture, repetition, and atmosphere.

Against the restrained material palette, the graphic identity—developed by Studio Round—emerges with clarity and precision. The neutrality of terrazzo, aluminium, and galvanised steel creates a backdrop where branding can breathe. An integrated digital menu board is framed within the L-shaped joinery wall with a placement that is both functional and compositional.

Wayfinding is embedded rather than applied: a self-serve water station is highlighted by feature lighting and subtle graphic cues, reinforcing intuitive flow. The visual language

feels neither ornamental nor overly branded. Instead, graphics operate as an extension of architecture—crisp, legible, and aligned with the bakery's no-nonsense ethos.

The tenancy itself presented challenges due to an irregular footprint that required rationalisation. IF Architecture's primary intervention, an L-shaped joinery wall, resolves the plan, clarifying circulation while preserving operational efficiency. Queues form naturally around a central American Oak display table, separating bread, coffee, and dine-in customers into subtly distinct paths. The result is circulation that feels intentional rather than transactional. Congestion is reduced and stress dissipates.

Where movement dominates the retail zone, stillness is carved into the seating alcove. Awning windows open onto the street activating the frontage and allowing the city to bleed into the café. Folded galvanised steel bench seating rests atop a structural I-beam base, while a curved banquette doubles as both espresso bar and café seating. Timber stools and American Oak tabletops soften the industrial palette at touch points to allow for warmth.

Discerning guests may draw the elusive parallel between architecture and bread-making that is embedded in the project's philosophy. Both rely on repetition, refinement, and time to perfect. Here—where space, graphic detail, and baking converge—artisanal bread is refining the bakery typology while acting as both product and final flourish. It's something warm to be touched, a texture translated into the walls, and a ritual embedded in the very structure of the space itself.

To learn more about all parties involved in the architecture and graphics, visit ifarchitecture.com.au and round.com.au, respectively.

Spring 2026 Shoe Trends Are Freakier Than Ever: See Our Top 9

Andrea Bossi · Refinery29 Fashion

As fashion moves away from the clutches of “quiet luxury” and minimalist beige looks, footwear is feeling more fun than ever. In fact, shoes are in their freaky era .

“Everyone is embracing their whimsy. We’ve moved past quiet luxury, and we’re even numb to logo mania. Style right now is about self-expression, individuality, and having fun with what you wear,” designer Larissa Muehleder tells Refinery29 of what’s defining today’s shoe trends.

This spring, the coolest kicks are a spirited extension of the self, whether they’re a classic silhouette made with a non-traditional material or a retro style that’s been reborn. We’re not just talking about Tabis, traditionally Japanese footwear with a split-toe, which have been popularized by Maison Margiela. Instead, this season’s eccentric styles toy with the familiar to create something fresh, whether they came from a runway or seem more inspired by street style .

Read on for the top shoe trends that will dominate the transitional season, like high-vamp heels on the brink of a viral explosion thanks to Chanel’s revival , as well as playfully embellished styles that make florals actually feel groundbreaking for spring.

DashDividers_1_500x100

Low-Profile Sneakers

We’re in an era of “minimalist and slim sneakers that are more so lifestyle silhouettes and not designed for working out,” according to women’s sports expert and editor Vinciane Ngomsi . Rather than the bejeweled kicks or chunky dad shoes of recent years, today’s favorite sneakers have gone back to basics, usually championing a slim, low profile that feels reminiscent of nostalgic styles.

In the same vein, ballerina sneakers — often shortened to “sneakerinas” and also made with thin soles — are having their moment amid this retro-style revival. “There’s a softness and romanticism that continues to evolve in really fresh ways with this [ballet-inspired] aesthetic, and it takes us back to the dance aerobics of the ‘80s,” Muehleder says.

DashDividers_1_500x100

Strappy sandals, with or without heels, are a reliable spring-time classic, at least when “fake spring” is over. What makes the look stand out today is how it’s been tweaked from the typically neutral-hued leather version to something more personality-forward. The coolest strappy sandals right now feature dainty straps, colorful finishes, and jewelry-inspired details. “Even with simpler outfits, people want one piece that feels like a conversation starter and right now, that piece is either the handbag or the shoe,” stylist and Vin. designer Claudia Li Johnson says. Strappy sandals are an easy way to get the job done.

DashDividers_1_500x100

High-Vamp Heels

Interestingly, a more modest-looking heel has been taking over fashion. Enter, high-vamp heels, distinct for their uppers that cover a noticeable amount of the top of the foot. These, also known as glove pumps , are no longer your grandma’s heels.

Instead, today’s versions of these vintage-inspired shoes are being made to feel fresh as designers reimagine them in funky colors and singular heel shapes. Chanel — which seems to have been on the lips of all the fashion girls when its spring collection hit shelves mid-March, designed by Creative Director Matthieu Blazy — gave the look a boost thanks to its own array of high-vamp heels .

DashDividers_1_500x100

Breathable Ballet Flats: Mesh, Jelly, & Crochet

The mesh ballet flat moment may have first exploded years ago, thanks to then-creative director Pieter Mulier’s new Alaïa design , but the look is still going strong, albeit with modifications. Breathable, sheer styles remain trendy this spring, and it’s not just about mesh anymore. Jelly and crochet, which tend to channel a more fun and colorful vibe, are now dominating.

Getting ballet flats in jelly materials can also be a lifehack for saving cash when buying designer. After all, they tend to be the cheaper option when looking for a “luxury” version of the ballet flat. For example, just look at Jimmy Choo’s jelly flat that retails for \$495 in comparison to a similar style made in leather that sells for \$950.

DashDividers_1_500x100

It’s a slingback spring . Though the heeled design of these shoes seems antithetical to comfort, these are a favorite for exactly that reason. Thanks to their mostly open foot and typically lower heel, slingbacks are a great choice for that in-between weather where you still want to walk with ease.

“As a designer, it genuinely makes me happy to see women embracing their inner child,” Muehleder, who launched her eponymous line in 2014, says. “Authenticity doesn’t have an age limit. Style comes from what ignites joy in you, not what you think is expected of you.”

There’s no one right way to wear slingbacks. Pick your color and heel height based on what feels best for your personal style. A butter yellow slingback with a kitten heel does just as well as a designer pair that’s slightly taller with bows sewn onto the sides.

DashDividers_1_500x100

Peep-Toe Mules

Nike Celebrates the Paris Olympics With the LeBron 23 “Old Glory” Colorway

Hypebeast

Name: Nike LeBron 23 “Old Glory” Colorway: Pale Ivory/University Red-Midnight Navy-Metallic Gold SKU: IB9562-103 MSRP: \$219 USD Release Date: May 8, 2026 Where to Buy: Nike

Nike is expected to be expanding LeBron James’ signature footwear lineup with an upcoming Nike LeBron 23 “Old Glory.” Continuing to tell the story of the LeBron’s NBA journey, the new moniker pays homage to the Paris 2024 Summer Olympics. The thematic colorway immortalizes the moment LeBron James carried the United States flag during the opening ceremony, cementing his status as a global icon beyond the game of basketball.

The signature footwear lineage has a long history of blending statistical milestones with broader cultural narratives. While the team’s gold medal run heavily spotlighted talents like Stephen Curry and Kevin Durant, the “Old Glory” makeup chooses to emphasize James’ enduring legacy and leadership over a specific on-court performance.

Aesthetically, the basketball silhouette adopts a straightforward and patriotic red, white, and blue color scheme. At the heel, a custom crown-and-flag emblem is prominently displayed, symbolizing the superstar’s dual role as a legendary athlete and a global figurehead. To complete the commemorative design, subtle metallic gold hits decorate the mini

Swoosh and tongue, subtly nodding to the squad’s ultimate podium finish without overshadowing the primary theme.

JFK Jr and Carolyn Bessette Kennedy: how the 1990s power couple became today’s biggest style icons

Chloe Mac Donnell · The Guardian Fashion

The TV drama *Love Story* has brought their fashion back into the spotlight – and inspired nine big trends, from bootcut jeans to backwards caps

When images taken on the set of the Disney+ series *Love Story: John F Kennedy Jr & Carolyn Bessette* were teased on social media in June, fans were adamant that the show had got the styling wrong. The fictionalised drama details the relationship between John F Kennedy Jr, then the world’s most eligible bachelor, and the fashion publicist Carolyn Bessette Kennedy, tracing their courtship and marriage, which was lived out under the scrutiny of the press.

“This is fashion murder,” wrote one user underneath a picture of Sarah Pidgeon, who plays Bessette Kennedy, and Paul Anthony Kelly, who depicts Kennedy Jr. Such was the outrage that the executive producer Ryan Murphy was forced to defend the styling as “a work in progress”, which led to him hiring a new costume designer, Rudy Mance, to focus on the historical precision. Nine months later, the internet has done a U-turn, with fans now rushing to emulate the couple’s on-screen and off-screen 90s looks. In the past week alone, searches for “Carolyn Bessette style” have increased by 150% on Google. Here are nine trends that the fans are championing.

Continue reading...

Closer Look at Art Basel Hong Kong 2026

Hypebeast

Art Basel officially opens its doors in Hong Kong for the 2026 edition running from March 27 to March 29

The expansive floor plan features premier international galleries including Gagosian and David Zwirner

Attendees can expect a diverse showcase ranging from classical Pablo Picasso pieces to contemporary Takashi Murakami works

Art Basel Hong Kong 2026 has officially arrived, transforming the city into a global hub for contemporary and modern art. Running from March 27 to March 29, the prestigious art fair brings together a monumental curation of international exhibitors, showcasing an expansive mix of blue-chip masterpieces and cutting-edge visual experiences.

Walking the floors of the 2026 showcase reveals a dominant presence from some of the art world's most influential galleries. Massive booths from industry heavyweights like Gagosian, David Zwirner, and Almine Rech ground the international offerings. Meanwhile, Tokyo-based powerhouses Kaikai Kiki Gallery and Nanzuka deliver a heavy dose of Japanese contemporary culture, ensuring a dynamic balance between classic fine art and modern pop aesthetics.

The artwork on display spans multiple eras and mediums, creating striking visual contrasts throughout

the venue. Attendees can view historical touchstones from Pablo Picasso alongside the immersive light installations of James Turrell and the conceptual works of Emilio Isgrò and Simon Fujiwara. Leaning heavily into the contemporary and street-adjacent art space, the fair also features metallic robotic works by Hajime Sorayama and signature Superflat canvases from Takashi Murakami. Rounding out the cultural highlights are highly sought-after illustrations and character-driven pieces from Yusuke Hanai, Kasing Lung, and Yoshitomo Nara.

Art Basel Hong Kong 2026 runs from March 27 to March 29.

Art Basel Hong Kong Hong Kong Convention and Exhibition Centre (HKCEC) 1 Harbour Road Wan Chai, Hong Kong

Generalized Language Models

Lilian Weng (OpenAI)

[Updated on 2019-02-14: add ULMFiT and GPT-2.]

[Updated on 2020-02-29: add ALBERT.]

[Updated on 2020-10-25: add RoBERTa.]

[Updated on 2020-12-13: add T5.]

[Updated on 2020-12-30: add GPT-3.]

[Updated on 2021-11-13: add XLNet, BART and ELECTRA; Also updated the Summary section.]

I guess they are Elmo & Bert? (Image source: [here](#))

We have seen amazing progress in NLP in 2018. Large-scale pre-trained language models like OpenAI GPT and BERT have achieved great performance on a variety of language tasks using generic model architectures. The idea is similar to how ImageNet classification pre-training helps many vision tasks (*). Even better than vision classification pre-training, this simple and powerful approach in NLP does not require labeled data for pre-training, allowing us to experiment with increased training scale, up to our very limit.

DOJ confirms FBI Director Kash Patel's personal email was hacked

Ashley Belanger · Ars Technica Policy

Iran-linked hackers successfully broke into FBI Director Kash Patel's personal email, the Department of Justice confirmed to Reuters on Friday.

Reuters could not authenticate the leaked emails themselves but noted that the Gmail address matched an email account "linked to Patel in previous data breaches preserved by the dark web intelligence firm District 4 Labs." The DOJ suggested the emails appeared to be authentic.

On their website, the Handala Hack Team boasted that Patel "will now find his name among the list of successfully hacked victims." The hacker group taunted Patel by sharing photos of him sniffing cigars and holding up a jug of rum, along with other documents that Reuters reported were from 2010 to 2019.

[Read full article](#)

All of DOGE's work could be undone as lawsuit against Musk proceeds

Ashley Belanger · Ars Technica Policy

Elon Musk must defend himself against a lawsuit alleging that he unlawfully seized too much power as the leader of the Department of Government Efficiency (DOGE), a judge ruled Monday.

According to the plaintiffs, Musk needed Senate confirmation before directing DOGE on drastic actions like eliminating agencies, mass firings, and steep budget cuts. Allegedly going far beyond the authority granted in President Donald Trump's most expansive DOGE executive orders, Musk took every inch of power granted and then increasingly used it to overreach unlike any presidential advisor who came before, the suit says.

In her opinion partly denying a motion to dismiss, US District Judge Tanya S. Chutkan did not buy the US government's defense that Musk held no office formally established by law—and therefore did not need Senate confirmation and cannot be alleged to have exceeded his authority under the Constitution's Appointments Clause.

[Read full article](#)

ANALYSIS

Jess Cartner-Morley on fashion: there may be 50 shades, but there's only one Correct Grey

Jess Cartner-Morley · The Guardian Fashion

The true quality of a fabric is revealed by a neutral tone – one that beautifully offsets the brighter tones of 2026. Just don't mention John Major

Sometimes a colour name is a whole mood. Rouge Noir: the stamp of cult 1990s glamour. Millennial pink: the colour of overthinking and oversharing. Elephant's Breath by Farrow & Ball: the imperial age of the gastro pub.

I have a new favourite. Pairs is a lovely little Scottish brand which makes great quality socks at good prices. There are many cute names – Frosting Pink, Milky Tea Beige – but the one I just had to click on was Correct Grey, "a warm grey with nods to a classic British school sock", according to the website.

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A quick hack for looking A Bit Dressed Up? Just add a dash of shine | Jess Cartner-Morley

Jess Cartner-Morley · The Guardian Fashion

If you want to add some glitz to elevate your look, try shiny earrings, metallic shoes or a snazzy belt

Once in a while, it is fun to pull out all the stops and get properly dressed up. To wear something gorgeous and probably impractical, do your makeup carefully, rather than in two and a half minutes, and coerce a family member into taking a photo before you leave the house.

It is awards season, and red carpet fashion hoopla is all around us. But for those of us who don't have an Oscar nomination, the nights that call for weapons-grade glam are few and far between, especially at this time of year. Which is fine by me because, frankly, who has the time? In real life, for most of us, quick styling hacks when you want to look A Bit Dressed Up are way more useful than a ball gown. Accessories that elevate your look from blah to belle, easy tricks that give your outfit a sense of occasion. These, not the bells-and-whistles party dresses, are the real treasures of your wardrobe.

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Lilian Weng (OpenAI), Lilian Weng (OpenAI): The full implementation is available in [lilianweng/deep-reinforcement-learning-gym](#)

In the previous two posts, I have introduced the algorithms of many deep reinforcement learning models. Now it is the time to get our hands dirty and practice how to implement the models in the wild. The implementation is gonna be built in Tensorflow and OpenAI gym environment. The full version of the code in this tutorial is available in [\[lilian/deep-reinforcement-learning-gym\]](#) .

Lilian Weng (OpenAI), Lilian Weng (OpenAI): Special thanks to John Schulman for a lot of super valuable feedback and direct edits on this post.

Test time compute (Graves et al. 2016 , Ling, et al. 2017 , Cobbe et al. 2021) and Chain-of-thought (CoT) (Wei et al. 2022 , Nye et al. 2021), have led to significant improvements in model performance, while raising many research questions. This post aims to review recent developments in how to effectively use test-time compute (i.e. “thinking time”) and why it helps.

Lilian Weng (OpenAI), Lilian Weng (OpenAI): [Updated on 2021-02-01: Updated to version 2.0 with several work added and many typos fixed.]

[Updated on 2021-05-26: Add P-tuning and Prompt Tuning in the “prompt design” section.]

[Updated on 2021-09-19: Add “unlikelihood training” .]

Lilah Ramzi, Vogue (runway): Here’s what you missed at this year’s Doja Cat-hosted Vogue Vintage Market, where three floors of vintage treasures didn’t stay on the racks for long.

Lilian Weng (OpenAI), Lilian Weng (OpenAI): So far, I’ve written about two types of generative models, GAN and VAE . Neither of them explicitly learns the probability density function of real data, $p(\mathbf{x})$ (where $\mathbf{x} \in \mathcal{D}$) — because it is really hard! Taking the generative model with latent variables as an example, $p(\mathbf{x}) = \int p(\mathbf{x}|\mathbf{z})p(\mathbf{z})d\mathbf{z}$ can hardly be calculated as it is intractable to go through all possible values of the latent code $\mathbf{z}$.

Anna Cafolla, Vogue (runway): The fur-lined opera coat style has made a comeback via Conner Ives and vintage dealers, embracing yhr robe and its easy sense of glamour.

Ellie Violet Bramley, The Guardian Fashion: Response from British fashion industry has been jubilant and Kane’s first Mulberry collection is reportedly to be unveiled at London fashion week 2027

The British fashion designer Christopher Kane has been named as the new creative director of Mulberry.

The Glaswegian-born designer will relaunch the English heritage brand’s women’s ready-to-wear collection, with his debut reportedly to be launched in September at London fashion week, before landing in stores and online from January 2027.

Continue reading...

Laura Harold, Yoga Journal: Learn how to savor every step along the way.

The post Working on the Splits? This Unexpected Advice Will Help. appeared first on Yoga Journal .

Lilian Weng (OpenAI), Lilian Weng (OpenAI): In my earlier post on meta-learning , the problem is mainly defined in the context of few-shot classification. Here I would like to explore more into cases when we try to “meta-learn” Reinforcement Learning (RL) tasks by developing an agent that can solve unseen tasks fast and efficiently.

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